

lectual Property (IP) transfer, copyright terms and so on.

Digital currency-based mechanisms are expected to completely transform revenue channels of the entertainment industry. Through dedicated blocks run by service providers, audiences can ensure their payments directly reach the artists. This is beneficial for the recorded music industry, because revenues increase at a fast rate here.

Streaming drives the growth of digital distribution, creating more opportunities for independent artists.

With streaming, it is possible to listen to ten million songs by paying the price of one single digital album download. Music fans are taking full advantage of this by subscribing to or downloading applications that provide such services.

Most importantly, technology is continuously evolving to improve consumer experience in the media and entertainment sector, from enhancing search abilities to providing increasingly personalised and curated content delivery.

People want content on demand, customised to their interests and accessible anytime, anywhere they want. They are demanding greater access to data to carry that content. This demand will change the way data is packaged and sold. Just like our phones increasingly demand more space for photos and video, mobile providers will need to provide more space and fast computing processors to access the content that is being offered.

e-Sports viewers are a desirable population for marketers, as this demographic is propelling the sports' broadcasts towards established, mainstream media channels. Portability of smartphones with impressive screen resolutions and good Internet speed are playing a major role in future online entertainment.

Transformations owing to technological advancements

Power of the Internet coupled with blockchain technology has changed the way problems of ownership and proprietorship are tackled by distributors and institutions over their content databases. AR and VR technologies have helped create varied experiences from story-driven content to spectacularly rendered stories to experience-driven

- Books
- Business-to-business
- Cinema
- Data consumption
- e-Sports
- Internet access
- Internet advertising
- Internet video
- Magazines
- Music
- Newspaper
- Out-of-home advertising
- Radio
- Traditional TV and home video
- TV advertising
- Video games
- Virtual reality



Top segments in the entertainment and media industry (Credit: www.hiddenbrains.com)

entertainment. AR and VR combine real-world elements with virtual ones for compelling results. Pokémon Go and Ready Player One are two perfect examples of AR in action.

Innovations in voice technology hold the potential to alter how consumers search for and listen to music. Machine learning and AI will increasingly penetrate the media industry as the analytical sector develops innovative solutions to make data input actionable. Advanced analytics are used to make content compelling, personalised and transparent.

Algorithms deliver content in a personalised manner. For advertisers, this offers the chance to precisely target audiences based on the media they consume, increasing the chance of conversion.

Cloud infrastructure management solutions help media companies scale capacity, and advanced analytics allow them to anticipate demand for advertising inventory.

Technologies are emerging every month to help media companies accelerate their data-driven journeys. Access to smart technologies has grown on a wide range of products such as smart speakers, smartphones, connected homes and connected cars. This allows people to stay online anytime, from anywhere, and stream unlimited music, video and read books till they have Internet connectivity. This has also increased the demand for data to alter creation and improve delivery.

Facial recognition enables certain apps to detect a face, recognise facial features and create a 3D mesh that overlays the image over specific

coordinates on the face, moving with it. People can pose and take a photo of themselves with the features of a cat (ears, whiskers, tail, etc) blended somewhat seamlessly over their features. More recently, such apps have begun to provide the option of recognising features in a photo, and then using that as the overlay or to create a 3D animation.

AI and blockchain changing the way companies handle digital content

Digitalisation is rapidly changing the way content is created and delivered. Hence, media and entertainment businesses need to manage their IP safely. Blockchain offers a unique approach to store content and related assets, make transactions and establish trust. It provides proof of ownership, and can simplify and automate existing royalty payment processes based on consumption (streaming).

AI is making the process of creating new content significantly more efficient for businesses, publications and online creators. *Forbes* uses a bot named Bertie that recommends article topics for contributors based on previous output.

Similarly, AI can be used to quickly create new ads and movie trailers, automated subtitling and streamline pre- and post-production processes, making all steps involved more cohesive, less costly and faster. With the use of AI, behavioural data and facial recognition ads have become so personalised that every ad out there is directed at a specific buyer persona.

Advances in AI-assisted localisation processes will pave the way